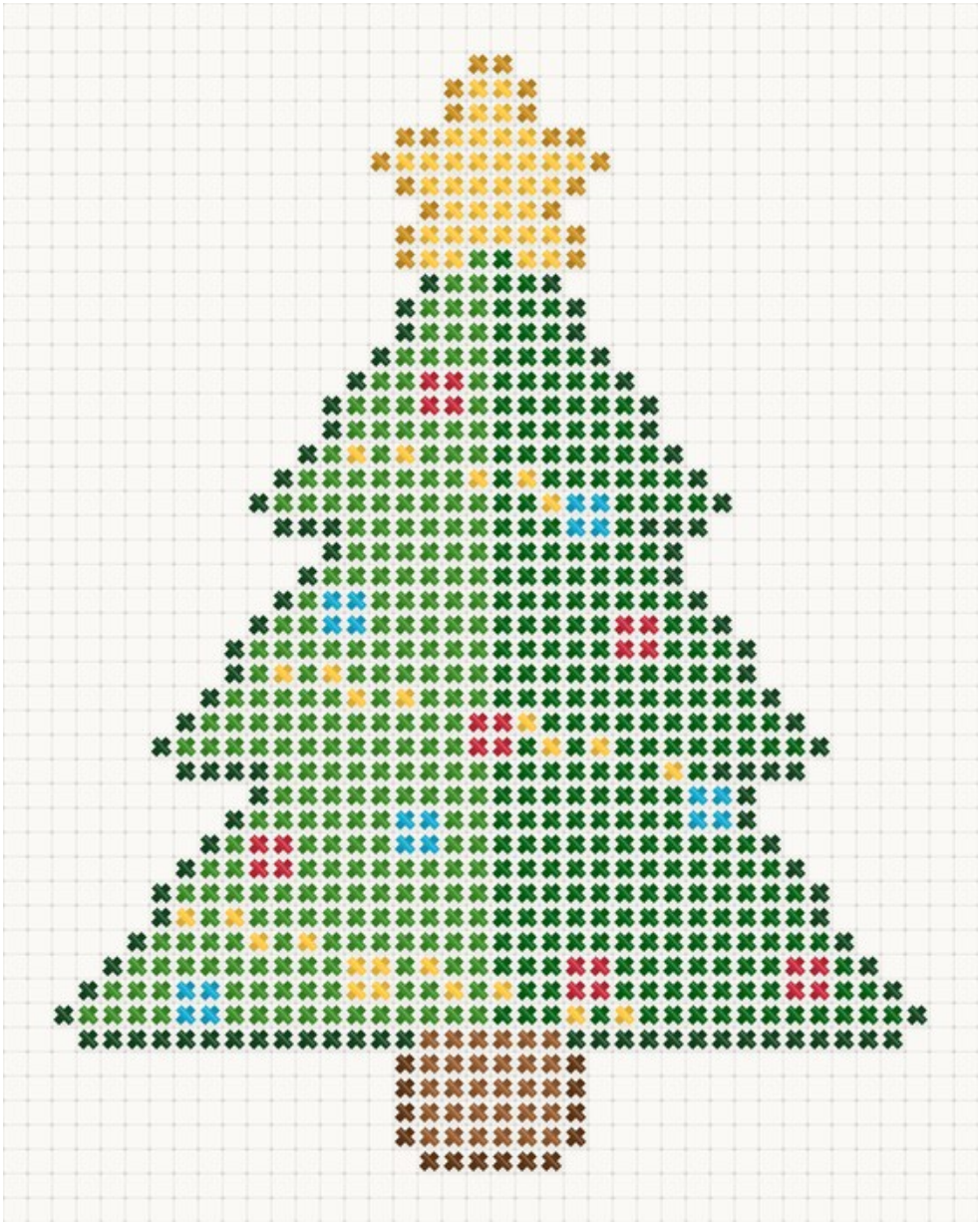
FREE CROSS-STITCH PATTERN

Merry Little Tree

A free cross-stitch ornament pattern · DMC thread numbers · 14, 16 and 18 count



Merry Little Tree

Gridleaf Studio

gridleafstudio.com · DMC thread numbers · sizes for 14, 16 and 18 count

How to use these charts

Reading the charts

- Each square is one full cross stitch. Squares with no symbol are left as bare fabric.
- The colour chart shows every square in its thread colour, with a symbol on top. The symbol chart is the same chart in black and white: handy for grey-scale printing, or when two colours look alike on paper.
- Every thread colour has its own symbol, listed in the thread key on the pattern's first page and again along the bottom of each chart page.
- Bold grid lines fall every 10 stitches and are numbered along the top and left edges, so you can count quickly and find your place again.
- The green arrows on the bottom and right edges point to the centre column and centre row.
- Bold coloured lines are backstitch. Work them last, with 1 strand, along the lines shown.
- Bigger charts are split over several pages. A page map in the top corner shows where each page sits. The grey bars on the edges mark the rows and columns that are repeated on the next page to help you line the pages up. Stitch them once.

What you need

- Aida fabric: 14 count is easiest to start with. 16 and 18 count give a smaller, finer result, and 28 count evenweave or linen worked over two threads matches 14 count. Each pattern lists finished sizes and how much fabric to cut.
- DMC six-strand embroidery cotton in the colours from the thread key (or any brand, using a conversion chart).
- A blunt tapestry needle: size 24 for 14 count, size 26 for 16 and 18 count.
- An embroidery hoop a little larger than the design, and small sharp scissors.

Getting started

1. Fold the fabric in half both ways to find its centre, and start there with the centre of the chart. That keeps the design centred on the fabric.
2. Cut a length of thread about 18 in (45 cm) long and pull out the strands one at a time. Use 2 strands for full stitches (1 or 2 on 18 count) and 1 strand for backstitch.
3. Don't knot the thread. Leave a short tail at the back and catch it under your first few stitches, or use a loop start with one strand folded in half.
4. Work in rows of half stitches and come back to complete the crosses. Make every top stitch slant the same way for a smooth, even look.

Tips for a neat finish

- Stitch one colour at a time in an area. Don't carry thread more than about 3 squares across bare fabric at the back, because it can show through.
- Print the symbol chart and colour in or tick off squares as you go.
- Let the needle hang free now and then so the thread untwists.
- The skein estimate assumes about 1,200 full stitches per skein with 2 strands on 14 count. If you stitch loosely or with 3 strands, buy one extra skein of the main colours.
- When you finish, hand-wash gently in cool water if needed, roll in a towel, and press face down on a soft towel so the stitches stay raised.

Finishing your ornaments

Three easy ways to finish

1. Felt-backed ornament: press the stitching, then cut the Aida 2 squares outside the design, following its shape. Glue or stitch it onto felt, trim the felt 3 mm (1/8 in) larger all round, and add a ribbon loop at the top.
2. Pillow ornament: place the stitched piece face to face with a backing fabric, sew around it 4 squares out from the design, leaving a small gap. Turn, stuff lightly with fibre filling, slip-stitch the gap closed and add a loop of ribbon or cord.
3. Mini hoop: frame the design in a small embroidery hoop (sizes are on each pattern page), trim the fabric at the back and glue a circle of felt over it. Hang it by the hoop's screw.

Good to know

- On 14 count the designs are 3.3 to 3.3 in (8 to 8 cm) across their longest side; on 18 count they come out about 22% smaller, perfect for gift tags.
- Stitch a few designs on one strip of fabric and cut them apart afterwards to save fabric.
- For a hanging thread or loop that is part of the chart (backstitch), use 1 strand, or 2 for a bolder line.
- Add the year or a name on the back of the felt with a fabric pen for a keepsake gift.

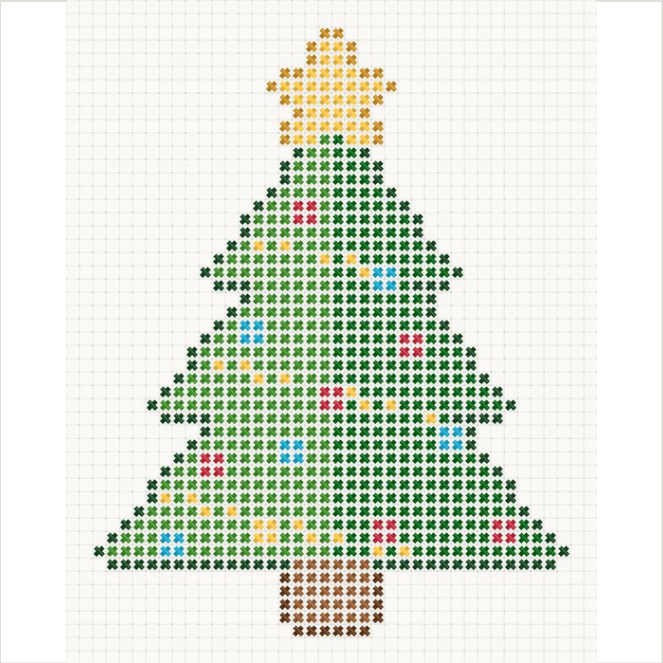
Gift ideas

- Gift tags, advent calendar pockets, card toppers, napkin rings, a mini bunting for the mantel, or one ornament per family member each year.

FREE PATTERN

Merry Little Tree

A three-tier tree with garlands, baubles and a gold star.



Design size

36 × 46 stitches · 772 full stitches
9 thread colours
Unmarked squares are bare fabric (white or cream)

Fabric	Finished size	Cut fabric to
14 count Aida	2.6 × 3.3 in 6.5 × 8.3 cm	6.6 × 7.3 in 17 × 19 cm
16 count Aida	2.2 × 2.9 in 5.7 × 7.3 cm	6.2 × 6.9 in 16 × 17 cm
18 count Aida	2.0 × 2.6 in 5.1 × 6.5 cm	6.0 × 6.6 in 15 × 17 cm

Cut sizes add 2 in (5 cm) of spare fabric on every side.
28 count evenweave or linen worked over two threads = 14 count.
On 14 count it fits a 5 in hoop; on 18 count a 4 in hoop.

Charts

Colour chart: page 5
Symbol chart (black & white): page 6

Thread key

Full stitches: 2 strands · backstitch: 1 strand

Symbol	DMC	Colour name	Stitches	Skeins*
●	699	Green	256	1
□	701	Light Green	246	1
✕	890	Ultra Very Dark Pistachio Green	100	1
▲	725	Medium Light Topaz	62	1
○	434	Light Brown	30	1
+	321	Red	24	1
■	3843	Electric Blue	20	1
◇	783	Medium Topaz	20	1
★	801	Dark Coffee Brown	14	1

*Skeins are an estimate for 8 m DMC stranded cotton: about 1,200 full stitches per skein with 2 strands on 14 count, rounded up (16 and 18 count use less). Total: 772 full stitches. DMC thread numbers are given for reference; screen and print colours are approximate.

My stitching notes

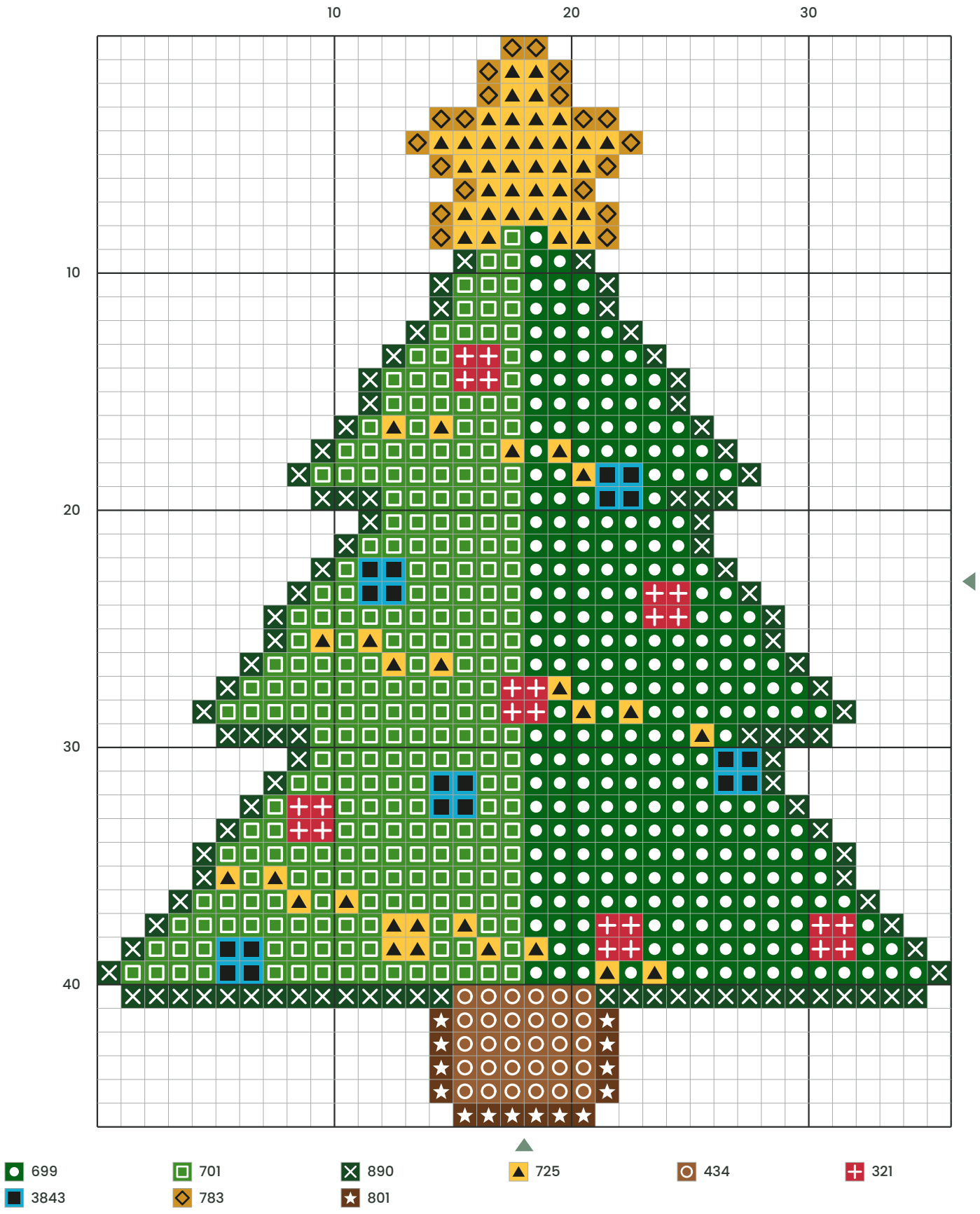
Started _____ Finished _____

Fabric and count _____ Made for _____

Merry Little Tree

COLOUR CHART

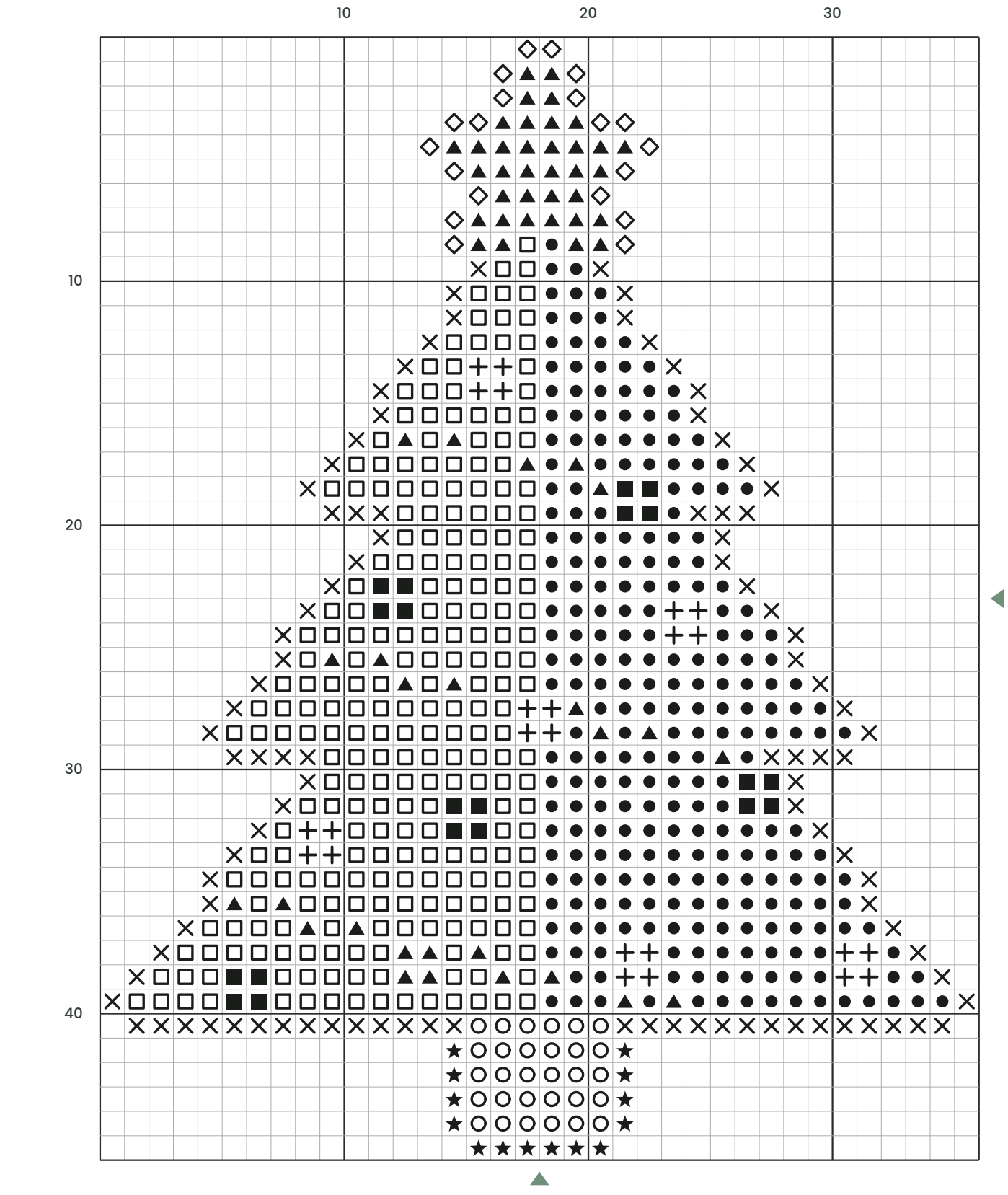
Columns 1–36, rows 1–46 of 36 × 46 · bold lines every 10 stitches · arrows mark the centre



Merry Little Tree

SYMBOL CHART

Columns 1–36, rows 1–46 of 36 × 46 · bold lines every 10 stitches · arrows mark the centre

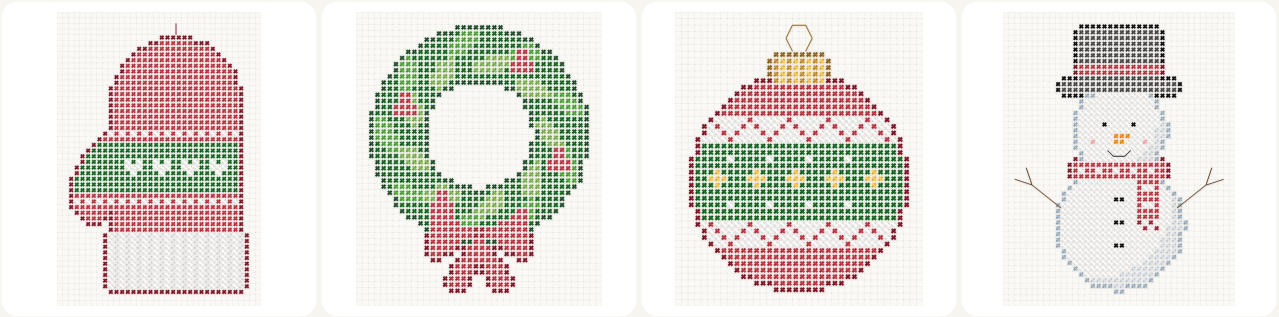


● 699	□ 701	⨯ 890	▲ 725	○ 434	+ 321
■ 3843	◇ 783	★ 801			

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About the designs

Every design in this PDF is original artwork drawn by Gridleaf Studio. The charts were made with our own software (with AI assistance for code and checks); every chart, stitch count and thread total was checked by computer.

DMC is a trademark of its owner. Thread numbers are given only as a colour reference; this pattern is not made, sponsored or endorsed by DMC. Any brand of six-strand cotton floss can be used with a conversion chart.

Thank you

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